



BECOMING *HIM*

THE COMPLETE BIBLICAL GUIDE

TO BECOMING A GODLY MAN

*Faith • Character • Strength • Discipline • Relationships • Fatherhood • Business
• Purpose • Leadership*

A godly man is not defined by status, money, physical strength or the ability to control others. Scripture repeatedly points to something deeper: a man who fears God, governs himself, tells the truth, works diligently, loves sacrificially, protects without dominating, provides responsibly, leads through service and remains humble enough to repent and grow.

"Be watchful, stand firm in the faith, act like men, be strong. Let all that you do be done in love." - 1 Corinthians 16:13-14

SEEK GOD • BUILD CHARACTER • MASTER YOURSELF • SERVE • PROVIDE • LEAD •
LOVE • BUILD

THE BIBLICAL VISION OF A SUCCESSFUL MAN Biblical success is broader than income. A man can win professionally and still lose his integrity, marriage, children, health or peace. Jesus asks what it profits a person to gain the world and lose his soul (Mark 8:36). This guide therefore treats success as integrated faithfulness: becoming the kind of man who can be trusted with responsibility in personal life, relationships, family and work.

A godly man is not a flawless man The Bible is full of imperfect men. The distinguishing question is not whether a man ever fails, but what he does when truth exposes him. Does he hide, blame and harden - or confess, repent, repair and grow?

THE 16 CHAPTERS

- 1. God First - establish the foundation
- 2. Identity & Integrity - become the same man in private
- 3. Self-Control - master impulses before trying to lead others
- 4. Strength & Courage - strong without becoming harsh
- 5. Discipline - build consistency and resilience
- 6. Work & Excellence - become diligent and useful
- 7. Money & Provision - steward resources responsibly
- 8. Leadership - authority expressed through service
- 9. Relationships & Dating - love with honour and discernment
- 10. Marriage - sacrificial love, faithfulness and partnership
- 11. Fatherhood - presence, instruction, protection and example
- 12. Communication & Conflict - truth without aggression
- 13. Brotherhood & Counsel - choose men who sharpen you
- 14. Temptation & Sexual Integrity - protect your mind and commitments
- 15. Purpose, Ambition & Business - build without worshipping success
- 16. Humility, Repentance & Legacy - finish as a man of good fruit

Use this guide slowly. Read the passages in context, reflect honestly and practise one concrete change at a time.

1. GOD FIRST - become a man under God's authority

Before a man can lead a family, business or himself wisely, he needs a standard higher than his ego. Proverbs 9:10 calls the fear of the Lord the beginning of wisdom. Matthew 6:33 calls believers to seek God's kingdom first.

"The fear of the Lord is the beginning of wisdom." - Proverbs 9:10

Faith beyond appearance Being a godly man is not merely attending church, using Christian language or appearing traditional. Faith should gradually affect honesty, sexuality, money, anger, work, relationships and the way you treat people who cannot benefit you.

Example: You are offered a profitable opportunity that requires deception. A God-first man does not ask only, 'Can I get away with it?' He asks, 'Can I do this with integrity before God?'

Pray before deciding. Bring important decisions to God before pride, fear or urgency makes them for you. Seek Scripture, prayer and wise counsel. Not every open door is a wise door.

Build a realistic spiritual rhythm

- Morning prayer before the day's noise.
- Regular Scripture reading rather than only inspirational clips.
- Weekly worship and Christian community.
- Honest confession instead of hiding repeated sin.
- Gratitude and prayer with your family where appropriate. Reflection: Which area of your life is most resistant to God's authority - money, sex, pride, anger, ambition, relationships or time?

2. IDENTITY & INTEGRITY - become the same man when nobody is watching

Proverbs 10:9 says whoever walks in integrity walks securely. Integrity means your private choices increasingly agree with the man you present publicly.

"Whoever walks in integrity walks securely..." - Proverbs 10:9

Stop building identity on status Career, physique, money, cars, attention from women and social position can all change. If your identity depends on outperforming other men, insecurity will follow you even into success.

Tell the truth when truth costs you A trustworthy man does not manipulate facts to protect his image. He keeps promises, pays obligations, admits errors and refuses double lives.

Example: You make an expensive mistake at work. Instead of hiding it, you tell the truth, take responsibility and arrive with a plan to repair the damage.

Character is revealed downward Notice how you treat employees, waiters, children, your mother, your partner when she is inconvenient, and people with less status. Respect that exists only upward is strategy, not character.

Test: If your private messages, spending, browsing, language and business decisions became visible tomorrow, would they support the man you claim to be?

3. SELF-CONTROL - govern yourself before trying to lead anyone else

Proverbs 16:32 says ruling your spirit is greater than conquering a city. Galatians 5:22-23 includes self-control among the fruit of the Spirit. Biblical masculinity is therefore deeply connected to restraint.

"Better... one who rules his spirit than one who captures a city." - Proverbs 16:32

Anger Strength is not screaming until others surrender. A strong man can feel anger without turning it into intimidation, threats, reckless driving, broken objects or violence.

Example: During an argument: 'I'm too angry to speak respectfully. Give me twenty minutes. I will come back and finish this conversation.' Returning matters; walking away forever is avoidance, not regulation.

Appetite and impulse Self-control applies to alcohol, sex, pornography, food, gambling, spending, social media, attention, laziness and workaholism. A man who cannot tell himself no becomes easy for appetite to lead.

Your 'no' builds your future Many successful outcomes are built by refusing short-term pleasure that conflicts with long-term responsibility.

Practice: Identify one impulse that regularly controls you. Add friction: remove access, create accountability, change the environment and replace the habit with a specific alternative.

4. STRENGTH & COURAGE - strong without becoming harsh

1 Corinthians 16:13-14 combines strength with love. Scripture does not require men to become passive, but neither does it define masculinity by aggression.

"Be strong. Let all that you do be done in love." - 1 Corinthians 16:13-14

Courage means doing difficult good. Courage may look like confronting dishonesty, protecting someone vulnerable, leaving a destructive environment, asking for help, apologising first, making an unpopular ethical decision or remaining calm under pressure.

Gentleness is controlled strength. Gentleness is not weakness. It is power that does not need to humiliate. Jesus describes Himself as gentle (Matthew 11:29), while still confronting wrongdoing directly.

Example: Your child disrespects you. You correct firmly without frightening him. Authority does not need emotional chaos to prove itself.

Protection without possession. A protective man considers the safety and wellbeing of those he loves. A controlling man uses jealousy, surveillance, isolation or money to restrict them. Protection serves; possession consumes.

Reflection: Do people closest to you experience your strength primarily as safety or as pressure?

5. DISCIPLINE - build a life that does not depend on motivation

Proverbs repeatedly praises diligence and warns against habitual laziness.

Discipline turns values into repeated behaviour.

Build reliable routines

- Wake and sleep at times that support your responsibilities.
- Train your body without making physique an idol.
- Plan the week before it becomes urgent.
- Do difficult work before endless entertainment.
- Keep commitments even when nobody is checking.
- Rest intentionally rather than collapsing from chaos. Example: A disciplined man does not need to feel inspired to pay a bill, train, prepare for work, call his children or keep an appointment. Responsibility becomes part of identity.

Discipline is not obsession Rest, recreation and enjoyment are legitimate. Discipline should create freedom and capacity, not turn life into constant self-punishment.

Recover quickly from failure One bad day is not a ruined month. Do not use perfectionism as an excuse for quitting.

Reflection: What part of your life repeatedly becomes chaotic because you wait until you 'feel like' handling it?

6. WORK & EXCELLENCE - become diligent, useful and dependable

Colossians 3:23 calls believers to work wholeheartedly. Proverbs 22:29 praises skill. Work can become a place where discipline, service, creativity and responsibility are expressed.

"Whatever you do, work at it with all your heart..." - Colossians 3:23

Become useful Ask not only how much you can earn, but what problems you can solve and what skills you can develop. Value creation usually precedes durable financial growth.

Do ordinary work well A man who wants leadership but despises small responsibilities is not ready for larger ones. Excellence is often built in invisible tasks.

Example: You want promotion. Instead of only demanding recognition, become more reliable: communicate clearly, improve skill, solve problems, arrive prepared and take ownership.

Avoid two extremes

- Laziness: expecting provision without diligent effort.
- Workaholism: sacrificing God, health and family to prove worth through achievement. Your job is something you do; it should not become the entire answer to who you are.

7. MONEY & PROVISION - build security through stewardship, not ego

1 Timothy 5:8 speaks seriously about responsibility toward one's household.

Proverbs also repeatedly values planning, diligence and wise stewardship. Provision is not identical to luxury.

Provider mindset A provider asks: What does my household need? What responsibilities are mine? How can I increase stability? He works, plans, contributes and does not use money as leverage for control.

Example: A man earning a modest income who pays obligations, saves and plans can be more dependable than a high earner who gambles, hides debt and spends for status.

Financial foundations

- Know income, expenses, debts and obligations.
- Build an emergency buffer where possible.
- Avoid consumer debt used mainly to impress.
- Save and invest prudently according to your circumstances.
- Give generously without neglecting responsibilities.
- Discuss money honestly with a spouse or future spouse.

Do not confuse image with wealth. A financed lifestyle can look rich while creating fragility. Proverbs 13:7 observes that appearances around wealth can be deceptive. Build substance before display.

Reflection: If nobody could see your car, clothes, watch or holidays, would your financial choices change?

8. LEADERSHIP - responsibility expressed through service

Jesus explicitly contrasts His model of leadership with rulers who 'lord it over' others (Mark 10:42-45). Biblical leadership is not permission for domination.

"Whoever wants to become great among you must be your servant." - Mark 10:43

Leadership starts with ownership A leader does not blame everyone else for the atmosphere he helps create. He asks what he can own, repair, communicate or improve.

Listen before deciding Leadership does not require pretending to know everything. Proverbs 15:22 values counsel. Wise leaders invite perspective, especially from people directly affected by a decision.

Example: In a family decision, 'I'm the man, so we do what I say' is domination. 'This affects all of us. Let's hear each other and make the wisest decision we can' reflects service and responsibility.

Authority should make people safer Whether leading employees, children or a household, do not use fear, humiliation, money or spiritual language to force compliance.

Leadership test: Do people become more capable, honest and secure around your leadership - or smaller and more afraid?

9. RELATIONSHIPS & DATING - love with honour and discernment

A godly man should not approach women as trophies, entertainment or sources of validation. 1 Timothy 5:2 calls for purity in relating to younger women; 1 Corinthians 13 describes love as patient, kind and not self-seeking.

Intentions and honesty Do not promise commitment you do not intend to give. Do not create emotional dependency merely because attention feels good. Communicate honestly about what you are seeking.

Respect boundaries A woman's no should not become a challenge to manipulate. Sexual desire does not remove responsibility.

Example: She says she wants to slow the physical side of the relationship. You may feel disappointed, but you honour the boundary rather than using pressure, withdrawal or guilt.

Choose character, not only attraction Attraction matters, but a wife may become your closest partner in faith, family, finances, hardship and parenting. Look for truthfulness, wisdom, kindness, self-control, compatible convictions and willingness to grow.

Do not play with multiple hearts If exclusivity has been agreed, protect it. Faithfulness starts before marriage through the way you handle attention, messages, flirting and temptation.

10. MARRIAGE - sacrificial love, faithfulness and partnership

Ephesians 5:25 gives husbands an unusually demanding model: love your wife as Christ loved the church and gave Himself up for her. Whatever one's view of household roles, the husband's calling cannot honestly be reduced to 'I am in charge.'

"Husbands, love your wives, just as Christ loved the church and gave himself up for her." - Ephesians 5:25

Love that costs something Marriage requires time, patience, sexual faithfulness, practical contribution, emotional presence and willingness to sacrifice preference for the good of the family.

Know your wife 1 Peter 3:7 calls husbands to live considerately. Learn what helps your wife feel heard, safe, loved and respected rather than assuming your preferred form of love is automatically hers.

Example: Providing financially while never being emotionally present may leave a family materially supported but relationally starved. Provision and presence belong together.

Repair after conflict Do not weaponise silence, money, sex, Scripture or threats of leaving. Learn to apologise without adding 'but you made me.'

Protect the covenant Do not nurture secret alternatives. Guard boundaries with other women and address marital problems directly rather than building an emotional escape elsewhere.

11. FATHERHOOD - your children learn manhood by watching you

Ephesians 6:4 calls fathers to bring children up in instruction without provoking them. Fatherhood is not merely financial contribution; it is presence, example, affection, correction and preparation.

Be present enough to know them Know their fears, friends, strengths, school life and interests. Children often remember attention more than expensive gifts.

Discipline without humiliation Correct behaviour, not worth. Do not use intimidation to make a small child feel your power.

Example: Your son lies. Instead of 'You're a liar,' say: 'You lied, and that is serious. There will be a consequence, but we are going to practise telling the truth even when it costs us.'

Let them see repentance If you lose your temper, apologise. You are not weakening authority; you are teaching integrity.

Model how a man treats women How you speak to their mother, women in your family and women generally teaches sons what masculinity looks like and daughters what treatment may feel normal.

Legacy question: If your son copied your current habits, marriage behaviour, money choices, faith and anger exactly, would you be proud of the man he became?

12. COMMUNICATION & CONFLICT - tell the truth without becoming destructive

James 1:19 calls believers to be quick to listen and slow to anger. Proverbs 15:1 says a gentle answer turns away wrath. Communication is a leadership skill in every domain.

Listen to understand Do not spend the other person's sentence preparing your defence. Ask clarifying questions. Repeat what you understood before arguing your point.

Speak specifically Avoid 'you always,' 'you never,' insults and character assassination. Address the actual behaviour and desired change.

Example: Instead of 'You have no respect for me,' say: 'When you interrupt me repeatedly in front of the children, I feel undermined. We need a better way to disagree.'

Conflict rules for a godly man

- No threats or intimidation.
- No physical aggression.
- No destroying property.
- No humiliation or degrading language.
- No using confidential vulnerabilities as weapons.
- Take breaks when needed - and return to resolve the issue.
- Own your percentage of the problem.

A man who can win an argument but destroy trust has not truly won.

13. BROTHERHOOD & COUNSEL - choose men who sharpen you

Proverbs 27:17 says iron sharpens iron. Men need relationships where truth can be spoken without performance.

Do not isolate Isolation makes secrecy easier. Build friendships with men who care about your character, marriage, fatherhood and faith - not only money, women, sport or status.

Choose counsel carefully Not every successful man is wise, and not every older man is mature. Look for fruit: integrity, stable relationships, humility, responsibility and the ability to admit mistakes.

Example: When your marriage is struggling, the friend who says 'forget her, go find someone else' may feel supportive while pushing you toward foolishness. A wise friend helps you examine truth, responsibility and safety.

Allow accountability Give at least one trustworthy person permission to ask uncomfortable questions about money, sexual integrity, drinking, anger, business ethics and family.

Reflection: Who can correct you without losing access to you?

14. TEMPTATION & SEXUAL INTEGRITY - protect your mind and commitments

1 Corinthians 6:18 calls believers to flee sexual immorality. Jesus also addresses lust at the level of the heart (Matthew 5:28). The biblical approach is not merely 'avoid getting caught.'

Do not negotiate endlessly with temptation Sometimes wisdom is environmental: leave, block, unfollow, do not create private opportunities, install accountability, avoid alcohol-fuelled situations that repeatedly weaken judgment.

Example: You know private late-night messaging with a particular woman is becoming flirtatious. Integrity means ending the dynamic before it becomes a physical affair.

Pornography and secrecy If pornography or compulsive sexual behaviour is controlling you, treat it seriously. Shame and secrecy often reinforce cycles. Use practical barriers, accountability and qualified support when needed.

Sex is not proof of masculinity A man does not become more masculine by accumulating sexual access. Self-control, faithfulness and honour are stronger biblical measures of character.

Practice: Write your non-negotiable boundaries before temptation arrives. Decisions made in clarity are easier to follow under pressure.

15. PURPOSE, AMBITION & BUSINESS

- build without worshipping success

Scripture contains diligent workers, craftsmen, merchants, administrators and leaders. Ambition can serve good purposes, but 1 Timothy 6:10 warns about the love of money, and Jesus warns against gaining the world while losing the soul.

Build value, not just image A healthy business solves problems, serves people, creates employment or value and produces profit ethically. Revenue matters, but revenue is not permission to deceive.

Business principles

- Keep agreements and communicate when circumstances change.
- Price honestly and deliver what you promise.

- Pay people fairly and on time where it is your responsibility.
- Do not exploit desperation, ignorance or trust.
- Separate calculated risk from reckless gambling.
- Learn continuously; competence is stewardship.
- Protect family time from becoming permanent collateral damage. Example: A shortcut could increase profit but requires misleading a customer. A godly businessman accepts that some money is too expensive if it costs integrity.

Define success before the world defines it for you Write your own scorecard: faith, marriage/relationships, fatherhood, health, integrity, contribution, financial stability, generosity, skill and peace. Otherwise money may become the only metric that never feels like enough.

Reflection: What level of professional success would not be worth becoming a man your family barely knows?

16. HUMILITY, REPENTANCE & LEGACY - become a man who can keep growing

Proverbs 16:18 warns that pride goes before destruction. James 4:6 says God gives grace to the humble. Humility is not thinking you are worthless; it is being secure enough to face truth.

Learn to say 'I was wrong' A man who cannot apologise becomes difficult to live with and dangerous to lead under. Repentance is not a speech; it includes changed direction.

Example: 'I was wrong to speak to you like that. You did not deserve it. I am sorry. Next time I will step away before I become disrespectful.' Then the next conflicts show actual change.

Receive correction Do not confuse disagreement with disrespect. Listen, test what is true and make adjustments. The inability to receive correction eventually limits leadership.

Think in generations Legacy is more than assets. It includes the emotional climate you create, the faith you model, the way you treat your wife, the skills you teach your children, the people you develop and the reputation attached to your name.

Legacy question: What do you want the people closest to you to say about the kind of man you were - not merely what you achieved?

THE FOUR AREAS OF BIBLICAL SUCCESS A man should not build one area by destroying the others. Use these four domains as a regular review.

1. PERSONAL LIFE - govern yourself

- Relationship with God
- Physical and mental health
- Self-control and discipline
- Integrity in private
- Learning and emotional maturity
- Rest and sustainable habits

2. RELATIONSHIPS - love with honour

- Truthful communication
- Sexual integrity
- Healthy boundaries
- Ability to apologise and repair
- Choosing a partner by character as well as attraction
- Faithfulness when nobody is watching

3. FAMILY - create safety and direction

- Presence, not only provision
- Sacrificial love toward a spouse
- Patient, firm fatherhood
- Financial responsibility
- Shared faith rhythms
- Protection without control

4. BUSINESS & PURPOSE - create value faithfully

- Diligence and competence
- Ethical profit
- Responsible risk
- Good stewardship
- Leadership through service
- Generosity and contribution
- Success that does not consume the soul

The goal is not perfect balance every day. Seasons change. The goal is to notice when one ambition has begun consuming responsibilities that should not be permanently sacrificed.

A PRACTICAL RULE OF LIFE FOR A GODLY MAN Use this framework flexibly. It is a structure for faithfulness, not a measure of worth.

Morning - ALIGN

- Pray before the phone.
- Read Scripture.
- Review the day's three most important responsibilities.
- Remember who needs your presence, not only your productivity.
- Choose one character quality to practise.

During the day - BUILD

- Do difficult work before easy distraction.
- Keep your word.
- Tell the truth even when inconvenient.
- Control anger, appetite and spending.
- Treat people with dignity regardless of status.
- Solve problems instead of automatically blaming.
- Communicate delays and mistakes early.

Evening - LEAD YOURSELF HOME

- Be mentally present with family where possible.
- Review spending and responsibilities briefly.
- Ask: Did I act with integrity today?
- Repair anything that should not wait.
- Pray, give thanks and prepare tomorrow.

Weekly - REVIEW

- Faith
- Marriage/relationship
- Children/family
- Health
- Money
- Work/business
- Friendships/accountability
- Rest
- One habit to strengthen next week

A man's calendar and bank statement often reveal his priorities more accurately than his intentions.

30 DAYS TO BECOME A STRONGER GODLY MAN

- Day 1 - Write the man you believe God is calling you to become.
- Day 2 - Pray before your phone and read one chapter of Scripture.
- Day 3 - Identify one private habit that conflicts with your public values.
- Day 4 - Keep one difficult promise you have been postponing.
- Day 5 - Review every debt, bill and financial obligation.
- Day 6 - Train physically and practise one deliberate act of self-control.
- Day 7 - Rest, worship and review the week.
- Day 8 - Apologise specifically where you have been wrong.
- Day 9 - Remove one major digital distraction.
- Day 10 - Ask your partner or family one question and listen without defending.
- Day 11 - Finish one neglected responsibility.
- Day 12 - Give or serve privately.
- Day 13 - Contact a wise man you respect.
- Day 14 - Define your sexual-integrity boundaries.

- Day 15 - Review your anger: what triggers it and what will you do instead?
- Day 16 - Create a simple budget or financial plan.
- Day 17 - Improve one skill directly connected to your work.
- Day 18 - Do one act that makes your home or family more secure.
- Day 19 - Speak encouragement to your partner, child, colleague or friend.
- Day 20 - Tell the truth about something you have been avoiding.
- Day 21 - Take a meaningful period away from work and screens.
- Day 22 - Write your definition of biblical leadership.
- Day 23 - Review your business/work practices for integrity.
- Day 24 - Identify one area where pride prevents you from learning.
- Day 25 - Do something difficult without announcing it.
- Day 26 - Ask for honest feedback from someone trustworthy.
- Day 27 - Create a one-year personal, family and financial vision.
- Day 28 - Have a prayer or faith moment with your family where appropriate.
- Day 29 - Write what you want your children or future children to learn from your life.
- Day 30 - Review the month and choose five habits to continue.

THE GODLY MAN CHECKLIST

- I seek God before ego, fear or appetite.
- My private life increasingly matches my public identity.
- I tell the truth and keep my word.
- I can control anger without intimidation or violence.
- I practise sexual integrity and respect boundaries.
- I work diligently and develop useful skills.
- I know my financial reality and take responsibility for it.
- I provide according to my capacity without using money as control.
- My strength makes people safer, not smaller.
- I can listen, apologise and repair.
- I love a partner sacrificially rather than possessively.
- I am present with my children, not only financially responsible for them.
- I choose wise men who can correct me.

- I do not need status symbols to prove my worth.
- I pursue business success without sacrificing integrity.
- I can rest without becoming lazy and work hard without becoming addicted to work.
- I am generous as my capacity grows.
- I am willing to seek qualified help when a problem is beyond my ability.
- I think about the legacy my habits are creating.
- When I fail, I repent, repair and return.

A PRAYER FOR THE MAN YOU ARE BECOMING "Lord, make me a man of truth, courage, discipline and love. Teach me to lead myself before I try to lead others. Give me strength without harshness, confidence without pride, ambition without greed, authority without domination and provision without control. Help me be faithful in private, diligent in work, wise with money, honourable in relationships, sacrificial in marriage and present as a father. Give me courage to admit when I am wrong and humility to learn. Protect me from temptation, laziness, ego and the need to impress. Let my business, home, relationships and personal life produce good fruit. May the people entrusted to me become safer, stronger and more loved because I walked with You. Amen."

BECOMING A GODLY MAN IS NOT ABOUT LOOKING POWERFUL. It is about becoming trustworthy with power, responsibility, money, desire, influence and love. Build a life your wife can trust, your children can learn from, your colleagues can respect, your friends can challenge and your conscience can live with.

SEEK GOD

- MASTER YOURSELF
- WORK DILIGENTLY
- PROVIDE RESPONSIBLY
- LOVE SACRIFICIALLY
- LEAD THROUGH SERVICE
- BUILD WITH INTEGRITY
- LEAVE GOOD FRUIT Important note: This guide is a devotional and practical application of biblical principles, not a claim that every Christian man must have one personality, income level, career, family structure or cultural model of masculinity. Relationship violence, coercion, addiction, mental-health concerns, safeguarding issues and serious financial or legal problems may require qualified professional support alongside prayer and pastoral guidance.